

PROCESS AUTOPSY

The prototype could not carry the ambition.

How founders of a mental health platform replaced a brittle first stack with a product that could match, meet, take payment, and partner, and raise.

When the first stack cannot carry matching, video, payments, and partners, funding waits.

Founders of a mental health platform. A clear product vision. An initial build that was already the bottleneck: wrong technical approach, slow to change, not fit for scale.

BEFORE

The platform they had did not meet the needs of the business. Matching therapists to people seeking support, native video sessions, payment processing, and partner portals all sat on the roadmap and could not ship on the existing foundation. Speed mattered: funding depended on showing a stack that could deliver.

WITH US

An audit of the tech stack against their ambition and real business needs made the constraints plain. Then a replacement build: matching, video profiles, video-based therapy sessions, payment processing, and partner portals. A platform customers, ops, and partners could run on.

OWNED BY

The company. Founders, operational staff, customers, and partners use it as the live product, not a side prototype.

TIMELINE

Audit of the current stack, then a focused replacement of the prototype with a scalable platform, followed by ongoing delivery as the product grew.

ONE LINE A PEER CAN FORWARD

"We stopped trying to stretch a prototype around the product we needed. We got a stack that could match, meet on video, take payment, and bring partners in, and we raised."

FluentForward builds the internal systems teams actually run on: apps they own, shaped around their processes. Paid Audit, Impact Build, then Strategy & Build. Not a two-year transformation.

Talk through your process

The prototype could not carry the ambition.

A mental health platform had founders, a clear product vision, and a first version of the stack that was already in the way. Matching therapists to people seeking support, video sessions, payments, and partner workflows all sat on the roadmap. The tech could not keep up.

This is how a short audit of the stack led to replacing the prototype with a platform the business could actually fund, partner, and run on.

The founders were building something specific. People seeking support needed a way to find the right therapist. Therapists needed profiles that showed more than a static bio. Sessions needed to happen inside the product, not through a fragile chain of third-party links. Payments needed to close the loop. Partners in the mental health sector needed portals that fitted how those relationships actually work.

On paper they were underway. In practice the initial platform was already the constraint. The technical approach behind it was wrong for the ambition. It did not meet the needs of the business. Changes were slow. It was not suitable for scale. Every feature they wanted to roll out hit the same wall: the foundation could not carry matching, native video, payments, or partner access without fighting the stack.

There was also a clock. They needed to move quickly to secure funding. A vision paired with a brittle prototype is a hard raise. Investors and partners ask whether the product can take load, whether ops can run it day to day, and whether the next partnership means another spreadsheet or a real portal. A stack that can deliver what customers, operational staff, and partners actually need is a different conversation.

FluentForward did not start by bolting features onto the old approach. We started with an audit of the current tech stack against their ambition and the real needs of the business. The audit made the constraints plain. Carrying the prototype forward would keep the product slow to change and short of what partners and customers required. The decision was to replace, not to stretch.

So the work was a rebuild shaped around how the platform needed to work for the people who would use it: seekers, therapists, ops, and partners. Not another licence to configure around. A system they own.

What shipped covered the spine of the product. Matching so the right therapists and people seeking support could find each other. Video profiles. Video-based therapy sessions inside the product. Payment processing. Partner portals so external relationships were not stuck in email and side tools. That is the difference between a prototype that demonstrates intent and a platform that can take commercial load.

The company owns the platform. Founders, operational staff, customers, and partners run on it. It is the system the business operates through, not a demo that sits beside the real work.

What changed shows up in the outcomes the founders were chasing. They reached a £2M valuation. Funding was secured. Key partners in the mental health sector came on board. Those numbers matter because they sit on top of a product that could finally carry the commercial story.

The quiet win underneath is fit. The platform can move at the speed of the business instead of holding the vision hostage to an early technical choice.

If you are sitting on a prototype that cannot carry the next twelve months of product, partners, or funding conversations, the useful first move is usually the same: an honest audit of whether the stack matches the ambition, then a focused build you own.

Talk through your process